

The Singing Spring

The sunlit hills of Greece roll down to a bright blue sea, dotted with olive groves, white marble columns, and little towns where everyone knows your name. High above, hidden in the clouds of Mount Olympus, the gods watch over the world, and the hills are full of wonders: riddling sphinxes, kindly centaurs, shy satyrs, and nymphs who sing by the springs. Here a hero is not the strongest or the loudest, but the one who keeps a cool head, asks good questions, and stands by a friend. The grandest deeds are done by being clever and brave and kind. Even a fearsome guardian, met with courage and a fair word, often turns out to be lonelier than it is wicked.



The Singing Spring

Read aloud, slowly and warmly. Stop often to let the children answer. There are no wrong answers here, only brave new ideas to try.

Before you begin

The Singing Spring has gone quiet. High in the hills, the water used to sing all day, and its song kept every well in the town full and cool. Now the song has stopped. The wells are low. The olive trees are thirsty.

Old Daphne, who keeps the olive grove, calls you to her. "You two have clever heads and kind hearts," she says. "Will you climb the hill and wake the spring?"

She gives you three gifts: a ball of golden thread, a honey cake, and a little lyre. Then she smiles. "Up here we do not win by being the strongest. We win by being clever, brave, and kind."

What is your hero name? Are you a hero of Wits, of Courage, or of Heart?

Stop 1: The Riddle Gate

You climb the sunny road and come to a tall marble gate. On the steps sits a sphinx, big as a lion, with golden wings and a kind, clever face.

"None may pass," she says, "until they answer my riddle." She is not cross. She likes a good thinking face.

What could you do? Could you listen closely and think it through together? A brave guess is allowed too. Try something and see.

When you answer, the sphinx dips her wings and lets you by. "Well thought," she purrs. The gate swings open.

Stop 2: The Winding Maze

Past the gate is a maze of old stone walls. Every path looks the same. It would be easy to get lost.

A cheerful satyr with goat legs pops his head over a wall. It is Bramble. He hums a little tune and points down one path with a wink.

How will you keep from getting lost? You have a ball of golden thread. What could you do with it? Could you ask Bramble for a hint?

When you tie the thread at the start and follow it on, you never lose your way. You come out the other side, into the evening light.

Stop 3: The Lonely Giant

At last you reach the spring. But a huge giant sits in front of it, with one big eye and a deep, sad face. He folds his arms. He looks fearsome.

But listen. He sniffs. Is he, maybe, a little bit lonely? Nobody ever comes to visit him.

This is not a fight. What kind thing could you do? You have a honey cake to share. You could ask his name. You could tell him he is not alone. What do you try?

When you are kind to him, the giant's big eye fills with happy tears. He shuffles aside. "Thank you for being my friends," he says softly.

The Spring Sings Again

Now you stand at the quiet spring. You take out the little lyre and play a simple tune, straight from the heart.

The water shivers. Gentle nymphs rise up in the spray, laughing and singing. The spring bursts back to life! Far below, every well in the town fills up cool and clear.

High on the mountain, wise Athena smiles down at you. You did it together. You were clever, you were brave, and most of all, you were kind. Well done, heroes.

The Story in Pictures



A friendly winged sphinx on sunlit marble steps tilting her kind face, two small heroes thinking below.



Two heroes in a sunlit stone maze trailing a glowing golden thread, a cheerful satyr pointing the way.



A huge gentle one-eyed giant by a cave looking shy and sad, two small heroes offering a honey cake with kind smiles.



A clear spring bursting back to life, gentle water nymphs singing in the spray, a hero playing a little lyre as the giant smiles.

My Adventure Sheet

Draw your hero

My name

I am a hero of

My energy stars (colour one in when you spend it)



My magics



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can

What I carry

Notes

Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.

Wits and Wonder

Story Pack

<https://github.com/agigante80/wits-and-wonder>

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